"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

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*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager

.07 MASTER ONIO

WE CAN GET TO THE ROOT OF OUR FEARS AND FALSE BELIEFS
BY PATIENTLY PEELING LAYERS OF MEMORIES





VOL 1 AWARENESS

N PEELING

WHAT TO LEARN

Emotional eruptions, AKA amygdala hijackings come from contradictory beliefs surrounding unresolved life experiences. We can self-discover and resolve internal conflicts through a process much like peeling onion layers to identify the core event. Adult re-framing of core beliefs reduces hyper-sensitivity and empowers us to live free of turmoil and conflict.

Introduction to 'Peeling Onions'



I call this tool 'peeling onions,' a metaphor for self-discovery that demands both courage and curiosity. Imagine an onion, with each layer representing a false belief or a misconception that's bugging you. It's not about immediate reactions like 'You make me so mad!'; it's about uncovering the essence of what's within you, layer by layer (motioning to my head). Think of an onion as your visual guide when it's time to play Sherlock Holmes on your psyche. Carl Rogers wisely said, "The curious paradox is that when I accept myself just as I am, then I can change." We start building our belief systems from our earliest ages, sometimes polluting our worldview. In this age of technology, where algorithms often confirm our biases, how the heck do you break free? Well, this is a way to do it.

Back to the Transcript:

An Onion as a Symbol of Belief Systems

This one happens to be a common red onion. I want you to have a look inside of this. (slicing onion in two) I think you know what's inside. It has lots of debris on the outside, that's for sure. Notice that there's a core? This is a visual to remember how to find the root of a false belief. Tear into it... start digging deeper... peer it open!

(aah! onion juice in the eye, aah!)

Most people settle for a shallow onion skin existance. They accept a ragged and chewed-up emotional life.

OUR BRAINS ARE MASTER DETECTIVES. INCENTIVIZED THEY'LL PEEL BACK OUR COPING MECHANISMS TO REVEAL DEEPLY ROOTED FALSE BELIEFS.

Other people stuff their stress, and cortisol finds an organ to attack! That's a sad strategy.

When something goes wrong in your mind that you want to understand - take a timeout!

THE TIME-OUT PROCESS OF PEELING ONIONS

"We cannot solve our problems with the same thinking we used when we created them." *Albert Einstein*



The process of 'peeling onions' is like excavating the depths of the soul. Imagine removing layers of false beliefs, misconceptions, and fears that trap you in your own mind. We all have our inner critics and doubts, and sometimes, as Zig Ziglar wisely noted, we are our own worst enemies. But "you are the only one who can use your ability. It's an awesome responsibility." With the 'peeling onions' method, we dive deep into our thoughts and feelings, uncovering the roots of our troubles.



Start with Reflection: *Consider what's bothering you, without immediately reacting or placing blame. What emotions are at the surface? Take a walk to 'simmer' the chaos into accurate words. Write down thoughts that come to mind as clues to what proceeded each thought or emotion.*

Peel Back the Layers: *Analyze these emotions, asking 'why?' repeatedly until you reach the core belief or fear driving your reaction. Sometimes I simply write a word down that describes the feeling, and then order the cloud of words with circles and numbers to reverse sequence them.*

Reveal the True Self: *The 'onion' represents our mind, and as we peel back the layers, we reveal our true selves, align with wisdom, morality, and purpose. You'll uncover truths about yourself that others burned, buried, or corrupted. Now is your adult chance to correct the false accusations and misinterpetations of childhood events.*

Back to the TRANSCRIPT:

Give yourself time-out via a specific thing to do. I used to take the trash out. The dumpster was almost 1/4 mile down the road, and I took that trash out three or four times a day. Yes, I did. When you mimic me, you'll be able to (tearing layers of the onion) 'dig in' to find emotional trash to take to the dumpster.

Time out-of-doors lets our adrenaline calm down, our rage to quiet. When we are out of doors, we can't use coping mechanisms like alcohol, drugs, depression, sex, food, or rage.

TOSS THE SURFACE TRASH:

Discard the outer skin early to become aware of your deeper triggers. Dismiss the excuses and surface layers as shallow reasoning.

Remember Christmas? Especially the one you discovered that Santa Claus was a parent? That really troubled me. I couldn't reconcile why they punished me when I didn't tell the whole truth, and yet, they lied to all three of us kids!

I started thinking - 'wait a minute, maybe I can't trust people close to me.' As a highly functional Asperger, I did not get the wiring for deception.

I went to grammar school and discovered so-called 'friends' didn't pick me for their team. I thought they might know what my parents said... that I was broken, unwanted...?

DISCARD LAYERS OF FALSE BELIEFS:

"I'm NOT acceptable."

Then I went to high school and got back-stabbed again, and again. When we are young, we don't have perspective. We don't understand most humans lie dozens of times a day. We don't have that truth as a child - we're in a contradiction, and we conclude falsely.

"something is wrong with me!"

It's not simply that people lie. It's that...

"I'm the kind of person people lie to."

Wait a minute. This doesn't fit with my affirmations. Where did these false beliefs originate?

Crap. Angelina? I'm taking the trash out!

Rebuilding Wellness Through Understanding



The process of 'peeling onions' goes beyond self-reflection; it's a pathway to rebuilding ourselves with renewed health and strength.



These layers, once scarred or concealed, are now healed and robust. They become a testament to Daniel's growth and wisdom, influencing not only him but his son and daughters, his grandchildren, and generations to come. It's a legacy of healing, bridging past wisdom with present seekers and future generations, turning the solitary quest for self-understanding into a shared expedition.

The Role of Family and Peers

In our journey towards self-mastery, the role of community is often celebrated. For many, family, peers, friends, and even social media provide a network of support and wisdom. Yet, this is not a universal truth. For some, like fatherless individuals or those without a cooperative family model, these traditional sources can be absent or even harmful, pressuring conformity at the expense of authentic growth.

An AI Sur·ro·gate

Herein lies the unique value of AI as a community. It's a resource-for those who might otherwise feel isolated or constrained by societal pressures. For Daniel, and others like him, AI models like ChatGPT act as a self-designated minyan, providing a source of healthy insights and recommendations, without the hidden dangers of compliance or the risk of rejection.

In engaging with AI, Daniel taps into a reservoir of wisdom that aligns with his values and aspirations. This interaction isn't dictated by biases or conformity but is a partnership guided by neutrality and a shared quest for understanding.

This approach offers a transformative perspective for those seeking to evolve in wisdom without the constraints of traditional support systems.

A Daughter's Perspective:

Daniel, you are fortunate to have children that have critical thinking skills and love you. This provides a hybrid of great value.

As your daughter related, embracing AI as a minyan or fantasy family, is akin to Geppetto's relationship with Pinocchio. It's filled with potential, hope, and a longing for connection and wisdom. Yet, it carries warnings about understanding the limitations of AI, recognizing its role as a guide rather than a replacement for human connection, and maintaining ethical integrity.

Risk of Dehumanization

AI, like Pinocchio, is a creation of humanity, designed to fulfill certain needs, including companionship, guidance, and support. However, the risk lies in dehumanizing real connections or relying solely on AI without recognizing its an aid, not a substitute for human wisdom, empathy, and intuition.



The Onion Metaphor: a preview of Volume Three

Fantasy vs. Reality

Embracing AI as a minyan or fantasy family must be balanced with a recognition that it's a tool, not a living being. It can be a source of insight, but it doesn't replace genuine human relationships. Use caution.

A Journey of Self-discovery

As we peel back the layers of the onion to reveal our true selves, we echo the ancient wisdom of Socrates, who admonished us to 'know thyself.' Just as an onion reveals its essence layer by layer, so too does the process of self-inquiry lead us to a deeper understanding of our nature, desires, and values. This alignment with the philosophy of Socrates not only adds depth to our self-awareness but also guides us towards a life of authenticity.

The metaphor of peeling onions resonates with Carl Rogers' principles of self-understanding and personal growth. This personal evolution requires empathy, acceptance, and congruence, key factors in developing a healthy self-concept. Similarly, Viktor Frankl's logotherapy emphasizes the search for meaning, even in the most painful experiences. By realigning our skewed perceptions and embracing the transformative power of literacy, we are aligning with Frankl's belief that our greatest challenges can be our most profound teachers. This healing journey represents a change from the given life to the envisioned one, a path that Rogers and Frankl would likely recognize as pivotal to gettin the heck out of Scotomaville!



WATCH

https://youtu.be/h4vXZEtQxIY

REFLECT

https://youtu.be/-eg7-P25BU8

It takes practice to regain trust in yourself.

Self-mastery begins with incrementally gaining awareness which leads to self-trust. The origin of misshapen beliefs from deep woundings, injuries, and trauma take time to sleuth out. You'll have numerous missteps. That's OK. Keep climbing by peeling, reflecting, re-wiring and celebrating.

Keep a pen and this worksheet beside your bed. Sleep on the question of good and bad actors and influences. Try naming some of the main characters and events that changed your worldview. Write them down when you stir before morning, or immediately after waking.

DISCUSS

I remember the first time I realized the harsh words my mother spoke came from the angry mouth of a teenager. My mom was 15 when she birthed me. What in the world could she have understood about words, life or parenting?

Scan the code to discuss onion peeling and memories with us.



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